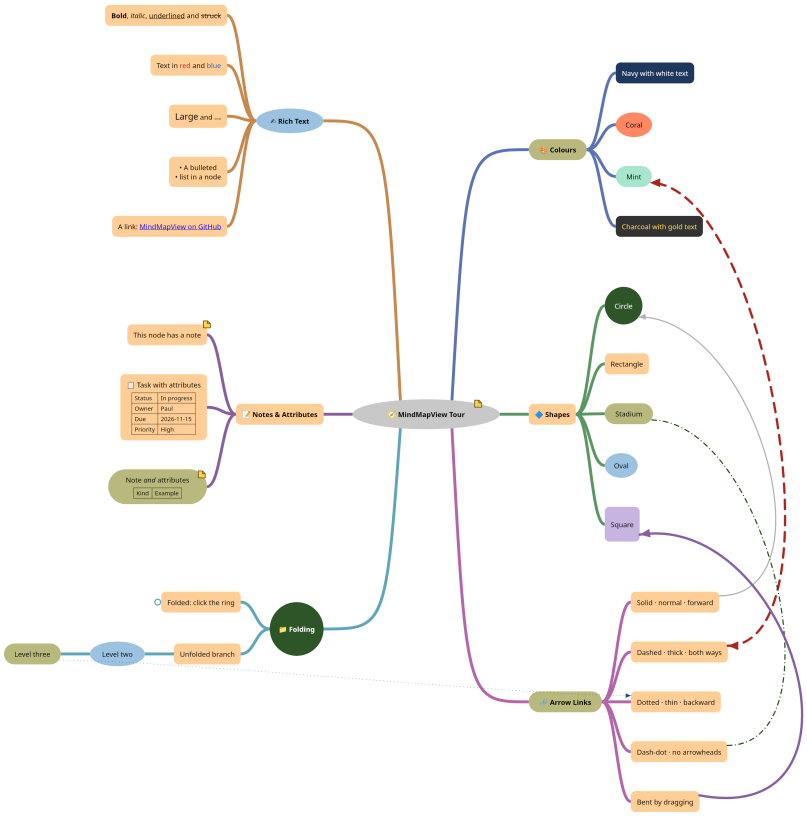
MindMapView

User Manual



Version 1.1.0 · for the desktop app and the web app

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1. Introduction

MindMapView is a mind map editor. A mind map starts from one central idea, the **root**, with related ideas branching out from it. Each idea is a **node**: a shape with text in it. You can give a node a note, attributes, links and an emoji, color it, fold its branch away, and draw arrows between any two nodes.

MindMapView runs in two ways that work the same:

- **The desktop app**, installed on your computer.
- **The web app**, in your browser at corbettcode.github.io/MindMapView, with nothing to install. Section 16 lists where it differs.

Maps are saved in MindMapView's own **.mmv** format, which keeps everything about a map. MindMapView also opens and exports **FreeMind (.mm)** maps.

> The map **feature_tour.mmv**, which comes with the source code, shows each feature of the app. Open it to explore while you read.

2. The window

The window has three parts:

- **The menu bar** along the top, with the **File**, **Edit**, **View** and **Help** menus. Each menu item that has a keyboard shortcut shows it on the right.
- **The find bar** below the menus, shown while you search the map (section 13).
- **The map**, which takes up the rest of the window.

A new map has only its root node, in the middle. The window's title shows the name of the file, and starts with an asterisk (*****) while the map has changes that are not saved.

The Help menu

- **User Manual (PDF)** opens this manual.
- **README** shows the project's README, for developers using MindMapView as a library.
- **About** shows the app's version.

3. Adding, editing and removing nodes

Adding a node

A new node is always added as a child of the selected node. There are three ways to add one:

- Click the **+ button** on a node. It appears on the selected node and on the node under the mouse pointer, where the lines to its children start. The root has a + button on each of its six sides.
- Press `+` to add a child to the selected node.
- Choose **Edit › Add** and pick the shape of the new node: Circle, Rectangle, Stadium, Oval or Square.

Each way opens the **Add node** dialog, where you give the node its text and style. A new node starts with the text *node_1*, *node_2* and so on. It takes the shape and colors of the last child of the node it is added to, so siblings look alike. The first child of a node gets the shape set in Preferences (section 15).

Editing a node

Double-click a node, choose **Edit › Edit**, or right-click the node and choose **Edit**. The **Edit node** dialog has these parts, from top to bottom:

Part	What it does
Shape	The node's shape. The root is always an oval.
Emoji	An emoji shown in front of the node's text (section 6).
Text	The node's text, with a toolbar for bold, italic, lists, links and size.
Fill	The node's background color.
Text color	The color of the node's text.
Note	A longer note, shown when the mouse rests on the node (section 7).

Press `Enter` or click **OK** to keep your changes, or click **Cancel** to drop them. To put a line break in the node's text, press `Alt+Enter`. In the note, `Enter` starts a new line. The dialog can be resized; the note gets the extra room.

If you change the shape while the colors are still that shape's own, they change with it to the new shape's colors. Colors you chose yourself are kept.

Removing a node

Select the node and choose **Edit › Remove**, or right-click it and choose **Remove**. The nodes below it are removed too. MindMapView asks you to confirm first, unless you turned that off in Preferences. The root cannot be removed.

Undo and redo

`Ctrl+Z` undoes the last change and `Ctrl+Y` (or `Ctrl+Shift+Z`) redoes it. Adding, editing, removing, moving, pasting, folding and arrow links can all be undone. Selecting nodes, zooming and moving the view are not changes, so they are not undone.

4. Selecting and moving around

Selecting nodes

Action	Result
Click a node	Selects that node alone.
`Shift` + click	Selects the range of nodes from the selected node to the one clicked.
`Ctrl` + click	Adds the node to the selection and centers it, or takes it out of the selection.
`Ctrl+A`	Selects every node that is shown, apart from the root.
`Esc`	Clears the selection.

With several nodes selected, you can cut, copy or remove them together.

Moving the selection with the keyboard

Keys	Selects
`Ctrl+Left`	The parent of the selected node, towards the root.
`Ctrl+Right`	The first child of the selected node.
`Ctrl+Down`	The next child of the same parent.
`Ctrl+Up`	The previous child of the same parent.

Panning and zooming

- **Pan:** drag an empty part of the map.
- **Zoom:** turn the mouse wheel, or pinch on a touchpad.
- **View › Fit** zooms so the whole map fits in the window.
- **View › Center Selected Node** (`Ctrl+Alt+C`) moves the view so the selected node is in the middle. Right-click a node and choose **Center** to do the same for that node.

5. Arranging the map

The six sides of the root

The root's children can sit on six sides, evenly spaced around it: left, right, upper left, upper right, lower left and lower right. Each side has its own + button on the root. The nodes below a child of the root grow outwards to the left or right.

Each branch from the root is drawn in its own color, which the lines and + buttons further down that branch share.

Moving nodes

- **Re-attach a node:** drag it onto another node. It becomes a child of that node, and the nodes below it move with it.
- **Change a branch's side:** drag a node onto the root. It joins the side of the root nearest to where you drop it.
- **Move a branch around the root:** `Ctrl+M` moves the branch the selected node is in to the next side clockwise, and `Ctrl+Shift+M` counterclockwise. These are also in the **Edit** menu and a node's right-click menu.
- **Move the whole map:** drag the root. The rest of the map moves with it. A root you have not dragged stays in the middle of the window.

6. Formatting text and emojis

The text toolbar

The node's text and its note each have a toolbar. Select some text and click a button, or click a button and then type.

Button	Effect
B	Bold
I	Italic
U	Underline
~~S~~	Strikethrough
•	Bulleted list
1.	Numbered list
🔗	Add, change or remove a web link (section 8)
Size ▾	Small, Normal or Large text

All nodes use the same font, which you choose in Preferences: Default, Inter, Lora, Nunito, Caveat or JetBrains Mono.

Emojis

Click **Emoji** at the top of the edit dialog to open the emoji picker. You can:

- Browse by category, such as Smileys & Emotion, Animals & Nature or Flags.
- Type in **Search** to find an emoji by name.
- Pick from **In this map**, the emojis other nodes already use.
- Choose a skin tone for emojis that have one. The app remembers your choice.
- Choose **None** to take the emoji off the node.

The chosen emoji is shown in front of the node's text, at the same size as its first letters. The dialog previews it in front of the text as you type.

7. Notes

A note holds more than fits in a node: details, lists, links or pictures. A node with a note shows a small note icon at its corner. Rest the mouse on the node for a second to see the note in a pop-up.

Write the note in the **Note** box of the edit dialog, with the same text toolbar as the node's text.

Writing in Markdown

Click **MD** above the note to edit it as Markdown text instead, for example `**bold**`, `*italic*`, `- list item` or `[text](https://example.com)`. Click **MD** again to go back to formatted text.

Pictures

A note can show a picture from the web with Markdown like `![description](https://example.com/picture.png)`. The note's pop-up appears once its pictures have loaded.

8. Web links

Text in a node or a note can link to a web page or an email address. Select the text, click the 🔗 button in the toolbar, type the **Address** and click **OK**. To change or remove a link, put the cursor in it and click 🔗 again.

Only **http**, **https** and **mailto** addresses can be linked to. Since maps may come from other people, MindMapView never opens other kinds of links.

To open a link:

- Hold `Ctrl` and click it in the node, or
- Select the node and choose **Edit › Open Link**, which lists every link in its text and note.

A plain click on a link only selects the node, so clicking doesn't open web pages by mistake.

9. Attributes

Attributes are name-and-value pairs, such as *Status: In progress* or *Due: 2026-11-15*. They are drawn as a small table below the node's text.

- To edit a node's attributes, select it and press `Alt+F9`, choose **Edit › Attributes...**, or right-click it and choose **Attributes**.
- In the **Attributes** dialog, type a **Name** and **Value** on each row. Click **+ Add attribute** for a new row, or ✕ to delete one.

- Buttons such as **+ Status** add a row named after an attribute that other nodes already have, to keep names the same across the map.
- **View › Show All Attributes** (`Alt+S`) and **Show No Attributes** (`Alt+H`) show or hide the attribute tables across the map.

10. Folding

Folding a node hides the nodes below it, so a large map is easier to read. A folded node shows a small ring where its lines would start; click the ring to unfold it. The root cannot be folded.

The folding commands are in the **View** menu:

Command	Keys	Effect
Toggle Folded	`Space`	Folds or unfolds the selected node.
Toggle Children Folded	`Ctrl+Space`	Folds or unfolds each child of the selected node.
Fold One Level	`Alt+PageUp`	Hides the deepest level shown below the selected node.
Unfold One Level	`Alt+PageDown`	Shows one more level below the selected node.
Fold All	`Alt+Home`	Folds everything below the selected node.
Unfold All	`Alt+End`	Unfolds everything below the selected node.

A node with children also has **Fold** or **Unfold** in its right-click menu. Folds are saved with the map, including in FreeMind files.

11. Arrow links

An arrow link is a curved arrow from one node to any other node, drawn on top of the map. Use it to show a connection that isn't parent and child.

Adding an arrow link

- Select the node the arrow starts from and press `Ctrl+L`, choose **Edit › Add Arrow Link**, or right-click it and choose **Link**. Then click the node the arrow should point to. Press `Esc` to cancel.
- Or hold `Ctrl` and drag one node onto another. Doing this again between the same two nodes removes the arrow.

Changing an arrow link

Drag an arrow to bend its curve. **Right-click** an arrow for its menu:

Item	Effect
Go to: …	Selects and shows the node at either end of the arrow.
Arrowheads	Forward, Backward, Both Ways or No Arrowheads.

Line style	Solid, Dashed, Dotted or Dash-Dot.
Thickness	Thin, Normal or Thick.
Color	The arrow's color.
Reset Curve	Undoes any bending, back to the arrow's own curve.
Remove Arrow Link	Removes the arrow.

12. Cut, copy and paste

- `Ctrl+C` copies the selected nodes, with all the nodes below them.
- `Ctrl+X` cuts them. Cut nodes can be pasted back, so they are removed without asking.
- `Ctrl+V` pastes them as children of the selected node.

These are also in the **Edit** menu and a node's right-click menu. Pasting within MindMapView keeps everything about the nodes: shapes, colors, notes, attributes and folds.

Working with other programs

Copied nodes also go on the clipboard as an indented outline of plain text, one line per node. You can paste that into a text editor, email or document.

Going the other way, you can paste text copied from another program. Each line that isn't blank becomes a node. A line indented more than the line above it becomes that line's child. Bullets such as **-**, ***** or **•** at the start of a line are left out. For example:

```
Holiday
    Travel
        Book flights
        Rent a car
    Packing
```

The new nodes look like the last child of the node you paste into.

13. Finding nodes

Press `Ctrl+F` or choose **Edit › Find...** to open the find bar, then type. MindMapView selects the first node whose text or note contains what you typed, ignoring capital letters. The bar shows which match you are on and how many there are.

- ▼ or `F3` goes to the next match.
- ▲ or `Shift+F3` goes to the previous match.
- ✕ closes the find bar. `F3` still finds the same text again afterwards.

Nodes hidden inside folded nodes are found too: their branch is unfolded to show them. Matches are found from the selected node onwards, so clicking a node and pressing `F3` carries on from there.

14. Files: open, save, import and export

The File menu

Item	Keys	Effect
New	`Ctrl+N`	Starts an empty map.
Open...	`Ctrl+O`	Opens a MindMapView (.mmv) or FreeMind (.mm) map.
Recent		Lists the maps opened or saved most recently.
Import...		Replaces the nodes of this map with those of another (see below).
Save	`Ctrl+S`	Saves the map to its file.
Save As...	`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Saves the map to a new file.
Export		Writes the map in another format (see below).

`Alt+F` opens the File menu.

Saving

Maps are always saved as **.mmv** files. The first time you save a new map, MindMapView suggests a file name based on the root's text. A FreeMind map you opened is saved as a .mmv file next to the original, leaving the original as it was.

If you start a new map, open another, or close the app while the map has unsaved changes, MindMapView asks whether to **Save**, **Don't Save** or **Cancel**.

Recent maps

When two recent maps have the same name, their folders are shown to tell them apart. If a recent map has been moved or deleted, MindMapView offers to remove it from the list.

Importing

Import... replaces the nodes of the open map with those of another map, but keeps the open map's file name. The next save writes the imported nodes to that file. MindMapView asks you to confirm first, unless the map has only its root. Import can be undone.

Exporting

Format	What you get
As Image (PNG)...	A picture of the whole map in light colors on white, including parts that are off screen. Folded branches stay hidden.

As HTML Outline...	A web page of nested lists, with notes and attributes. Branches can be folded in the browser, and start folded where they are in the map.
As FreeMind Map (.mm)...	A map for FreeMind and the programs that read its format. FreeMind only has left and right sides, so nodes on the upper and lower sides go to the left or right.

Exporting doesn't save the map: unsaved changes stay unsaved.

15. Preferences

Choose **Edit › Preferences...** to change:

Setting	Choices
Theme	System (follow your computer), Light or Dark.
New node shape	The shape of the first child added to a node. Later children copy their last sibling.
Node font	Default, Inter, Lora, Nunito, Caveat or JetBrains Mono, for the text of every node.
Ask before removing a node	Whether removing a node asks you to confirm.
Fill colors	The fill colors offered in the edit dialog.
Text colors	The text colors offered in the edit dialog.
Arrow link colors	The colors offered in an arrow link's menu.

For each list of colors, pick a color with the color picker or type its **Hex** code, then click **Add**. Select a color and click **Remove** to take it off the list, or click **Reset** to go back to the original colors.

Preferences belong to you, not to a map: they apply to every map you open.

16. The web app

The web app at corbettcode.github.io/MindMapView is the same app, running in your browser. It needs a recent browser: Chrome or Edge 119, Firefox 120, Safari 18.2 or later. It differs from the desktop app in these ways:

- In Chrome and Edge, **Save** writes back to the file you opened. Other browsers download the map instead.
- In Chrome and Edge, the **Recent** menu lists maps by name only, as a web page isn't told which folder a file is in. The browser asks you to allow the file again before opening it. Other browsers have no Recent menu.
- Pasting text from other programs asks for the browser's permission first.
- Pictures in notes only show when the website they come from allows it.
- Preferences are kept in the browser, so each browser has its own.

- Some shortcuts, such as `Ctrl+N`, belong to the browser. Use the menus for those.
- The browser warns you before you leave the page with unsaved changes.

17. Keyboard shortcuts

Files

Keys	Command
`Ctrl+N`	New map
`Ctrl+O`	Open a map
`Ctrl+S`	Save
`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Save As
`Alt+F`	Open the File menu

Editing

Keys	Command
`+`	Add a child to the selected node
`Ctrl+Z`	Undo
`Ctrl+Y`, `Ctrl+Shift+Z`	Redo
`Ctrl+X`	Cut
`Ctrl+C`	Copy
`Ctrl+V`	Paste
`Alt+F9`	Edit attributes
`Ctrl+L`	Add an arrow link from the selected node
`Ctrl+M`	Move the branch clockwise around the root
`Ctrl+Shift+M`	Move the branch counterclockwise around the root

In the edit dialog

Keys	Command
`Enter`	OK (in the note: a new line)
`Alt+Enter`	A new line in the node's text

Selecting and finding

Keys	Command
`Ctrl+A`	Select all nodes
`Esc`	Clear the selection, or cancel adding an arrow link

`Ctrl+Left`	Select the parent
`Ctrl+Right`	Select the first child
`Ctrl+Down` / `Ctrl+Up`	Select the next / previous sibling
`Ctrl+F`	Find
`F3` / `Shift+F3`	Find next / previous

View and folding

Keys	Command
`Ctrl+Alt+C`	Center the selected node
`Alt+S`	Show all attributes
`Alt+H`	Show no attributes
`Space`	Fold or unfold the selected node
`Ctrl+Space`	Fold or unfold its children
`Alt+PageUp` / `Alt+PageDown`	Fold / unfold one level
`Alt+Home` / `Alt+End`	Fold / unfold all

Mouse

Action	Result
Double-click a node	Edit it
Right-click a node	Its menu
Right-click an arrow link	Its menu
Drag a node onto another	Re-attach it
`Ctrl` + drag a node onto another	Add or remove an arrow link
Drag an arrow link	Bend it
Drag the root	Move the whole map
Drag empty space	Pan
Mouse wheel / pinch	Zoom
`Ctrl` + click a link	Open it
Click a fold ring	Unfold the node